

Participation

BUAD-304 | Organizational Behavior and Leadership

Instructor: Christine El Haddad

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	15%
Start date:	2026-08-24
Due date:	2026-12-04
Group project:	No

Grade Components (15% total)

- Active Class Participation
- Team Engagement
- Research Studies (2)

Overview (Course Evaluation)

Participation 15% - Active Class Participation; Team Engagement; Research Studies (2.0 credits)

Weight Breakdown (15% total)

- Active Class Participation - % of the 15% not specified in syllabus
- Team Engagement - % of the 15% not specified in syllabus
- Research Studies (2.0 credits) - % of the 15% not specified in syllabus

Syllabus note on sub-weights

Course Evaluation lists three components under Participation 15% but does not assign individual percentages (unlike Team Project 30%, which breaks down to 3% + 15% + 10% + 2%). The instructor evaluates participation holistically across all three components.

Research Studies - Credit scale (within its component)

- 2.0 credits earned → 100% on the Research Studies portion of Participation
- 1.5 credits → 75%
- 1.0 credits → 50%
- 0 credits → 0%
- Partial credits prorated; no extensions (Marshall Research Participation Guide)

Attendance Policy

Attendance Policy. Attendance is critical in this course. All missed classes will be noted. The policy on missed classes is to allow each student two (2) absences, no questions asked, no penalty. Missing three or more classes without a reasonable conversation with the professor will reduce your participation grade and final course grade. Students with an excessive number of absences are at risk of failing the course. Only official university engagements, such as officially scheduled USC Marshall sponsored case competitions and sports events, will be accepted as exceptions to this policy. Job interviews are not excused so choose your absences carefully. Habitual lateness and leaving class early, for whatever reason, will be noted as evidence of low course commitment and penalized. Simply put, you cannot learn from our class discussions, and your classmates cannot learn from you, if you are not present.

Team Engagement

Effective engagement with your team is also an important component of your participation grade.

Active Class Participation

Your participation grade will be based on consistent and effective contributions to class discussions and participation in in-class assignments and activities. You are expected to attend every class session having read, thought about, and prepared any assigned material. You should also be prepared to share your ideas and to actively listen to and interpret the ideas presented by others. 3

What Counts as Quality Participation

- Offer a relevant concept or personal experience
- Provide careful analysis by applying theory and concepts from readings and lectures
- Move the discussion forward by building on previous contributions with new insights
- Ask thoughtful and challenging questions.

Classroom Expectations

Our learning community operates in an environment of openness, respect, encouragement and engagement. Discussions will be richer if you share your unique perspective. There is rarely one right answer in organizational behavior! It may take courage or patience or imagination to engage with the course material, our classmates and our experiences. In our classroom, I aim to develop a psychologically safe space where we can all learn together and benefit from the diversity that leads to increased innovation, better problem solving and, in our case, what I hope will be new friends and a great semester!

Research Studies (syllabus)

Research Studies Participation. Please refer to the Research Studies Participation document in Brightspace for more information on this component of your grade.

Research Studies - 3-Step Process

- Step 1 (Register): Create SONA account at marshall-mor.sona-systems.com - opens Aug 24, deadline Sep 25
- Step 2 (Setup): Complete prescreening questionnaire + submit 3 employee contacts - opens Sep 11, deadline Sep 25
- Step 3 (Earn credits): Complete 3-6 lab studies (online or in-person) - invitations begin after setup; deadline Dec 4
- Goal: 2.0 research credits (typically 0.25 credit per 15 minutes of study time)

Research Studies - Key Dates

- 2026-08-24 (start): SONA registration opens
- 2026-09-11 (start): Prescreening questionnaire opens
- 2026-09-25 (due): Setup deadline (registration, prescreening, contacts)
- 2026-09-26 (start): Study invitations begin (after setup)
- 2026-10-26 (due): Employee contact surveys sent
- 2026-12-04 (due): Complete 2.0 research credits

Research Studies - Contacts & Support

- Marshall Behavioral Research Lab: mor.sona@marshall.usc.edu
- Guide online: bit.ly/MOR-BUAD
- SONA walkthrough (3 min): bit.ly/SONA-BUAD304
- SONA portal: marshall-mor.sona-systems.com
- Slack support: [#buad304-research-participation](#)